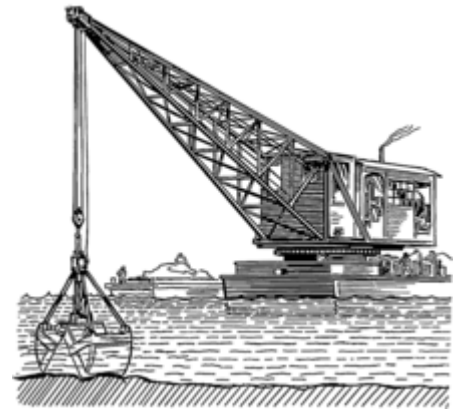


Dredging

Dredging is the operation of excavating material from a water environment (sometimes temporarily created) for the purpose of improving existing water features; reshaping land and water features to alter drainage, navigability, and commercial use; construct dams, dikes, and other controls for streams and shorelines; and to recover valuable mineral deposits or marine life having commercial value. In all but a few situations the excavation is undertaken by a specialist floating plant, known as a dredger. Dredging is carried out in many different locations and for many different purposes, but the main objectives are usually to recover material of value or use, or to create a greater depth of water.^[1] All dredges can generally be classified as suction or mechanical.^[1]



A grab dredge

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